

Capability Authoring Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe **what the business can do**, independent of team names, systems, or specific process steps.

This guide is about stable business abilities — the **what**, not the **how**.

What belongs here

- business capabilities
- capability hierarchy or decomposition
- links to important goals, concepts, rules, and operations

What does not belong here

- detailed workflows
- organization charts
- implementation-specific system descriptions

Core things to capture

- the capability name
- what business ability it represents
- how it decomposes into smaller abilities
- what goals it supports
- what concepts, rules, or operations it depends on

Core relationships to capture

- parent capability -> child capability
- capability -> goal supported
- capability -> concept/rule/operation involved

Modus operandi

Start with stable business language:

1. ask what the business must be able to do
2. separate that from teams, tools, and workflows
3. decompose broad capabilities into clearer child capabilities
4. link them to business goals and important domain elements

Prompt set

- what business ability are we describing?
- is this stable over time?
- can it be decomposed into smaller abilities?
- what goals does it support?
- what concepts or rules are central to it?

Free-text intake template

- **Capability name:**
- **Meaning:**
- **Parent capability (if any):**
- **Child capabilities:**
- **Supported goals:**
- **Related concepts/rules/operations:**

Worked example

- Leave Management is a top-level capability
- It decomposes into Request Leave, Review Leave, and Track Leave Balances
- It supports staffing continuity and employee self-service goals

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into capability entries and hierarchy links with traceability to goals, concepts, rules, and operations.

Common mistakes

- describing a process instead of a capability
- making capability names tool- or team-specific

- skipping hierarchy when the capability is too broad

